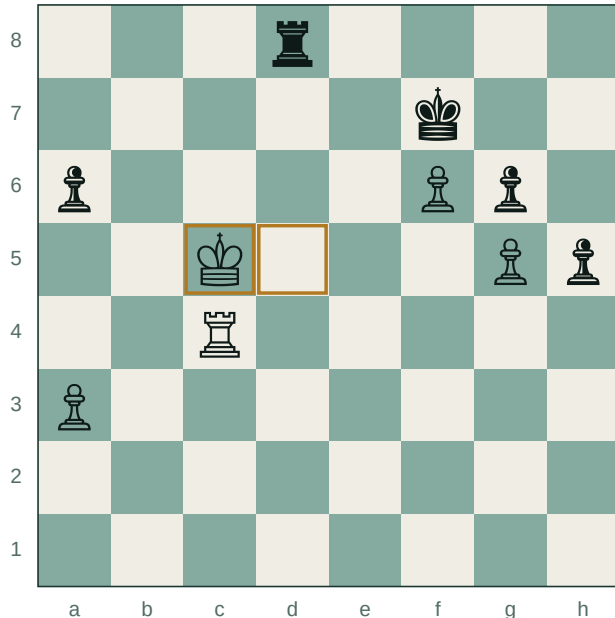


Active defensive resources: Black, move 51

Active defensive resources

Black to move



Previous move: 51.Kxc5. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

51...Rc8+ 52. Kd4 Rxc4+ 53. Kxc4 h4

51...Rc8+ Check restricts White to 5 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **52.Kd4**.

52...Rxc4+ Check restricts White to 5 legal replies here. The move also takes the rook on c4. Recorded reply: **53.Kxc4**.

53...h4 The pawn moves from h5 to h4.

At the end, nominal material is White 3 / Black 3 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +0. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +0: the balance goes from +0 to +0. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A defensive puzzle may aim to preserve equality rather than win. Judge success against the threat, not only the final material count.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

The best defense may create a threat, exchange an attacker, or change the geometry of the attack. Identify the opponent's concrete idea before selecting a response.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the threatened move and the conditions it requires. Look for a move that breaks one of those conditions with tempo.

The defending king is on c5. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.